

LG Super Multi GSA-E10L

Speedy backups!

LG's latest external DVD-Writer, the Super Multi GSA-E10L, has all the features you'd expect in its internal counterparts. The drive is housed in a ruggedly-constructed silver and black polymer casing, and seems strong enough to withstand rough usage. It looks decent, weighs just 1.26 kg, and can be carried around easily.

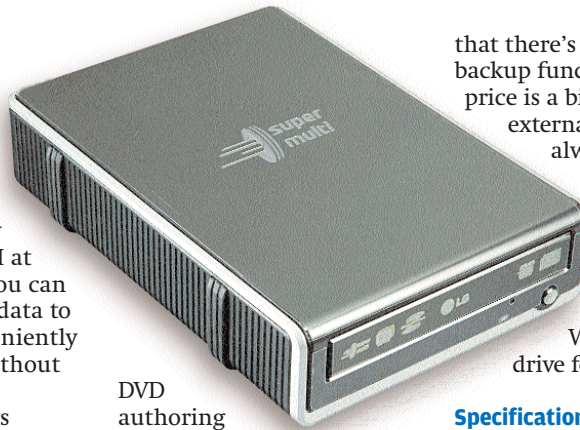
If you've got a lot of Hollywood DVDs and are worrying about how to back them up, forget lossy compression techniques! The Super Multi lets you back up uncompressed 8.5 GB dual-layer DVDs to dual-layer media at speeds as high as 10x!

With 16x speeds for DVD±R, it is one of the fastest external DVD-Writers available. Video editing

professionals and enthusiasts will love this drive because of its ability to write to DVD-RAM at a very speedy 12X. You can even drag and drop data to a DVD-RAM as conveniently as to a hard drive without the need for special software. The drive is LightScribe-enabled.

The interface is USB 2.0. The drive performed on par with its internal counterparts. It could write 4.5 GB on both the sequential as well as the assorted DVDs in less than 6 minutes, while a 700 MB assorted CD-R took around 3 minutes.

The drive comes with an impressive software bundle—Nero Burning ROM in addition to CyberLink's PowerProducer (a premium



that there's no one-touch backup functionality. The price is a bit high, but then, external drives have always been more expensive than internal ones. If you're in the market for an external DVD-Writer, this is the drive for you!

DVD authoring software) and PowerDVD for DVD playback.

You can adapt the drive to newer media by updating its write strategy via firmware upgrades from the Internet. One negative is

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Specifications

Writing: DVD±R: 16x, DVD+RW: 8x, DVD-RW: 6x, DVD+R DL: 10x, DVD-R DL: 6x, DVD-RAM: 12x, CD-R: 48x, CD-RW: 32x; Reading: DVD-ROM: 16x, CD-ROM: 48x; buffer: 2 MB; LightScribe; USB 2.0; dimensions: 163.2 mm (W) x 54 mm (H) x 230 mm (D); weight: 1.26 kg

Contact: LG Electronics India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 0120-2560900
E-mail: arastogi@lgindia.com
Website: www.lgebuy.com
Price: Rs. 6,320

APC Mobile Power Pack UPB-10

Intelligent design

The APC Mobile Power Pack (MPP) acts as a battery pack for charging mobile devices that have a USB connector. When your battery's low, simply connect it to the MPP to charge it!

The only button on the pocket-sized thing is used to show the remaining charge, represented by four white LEDs that light up according to the charge left on the unit. The UPB took about three hours to charge fully—which is decent.

The UPB has two USB connectors, so you can connect one to either the AC-to-USB adapter or to a laptop to leech power from. You connect the other to a mobile device to charge it.



Coming with a price tag of Rs 3,898, we can say it's well worth it if you travel a lot and power outlets are hard to come by.

Specifications

Dimensions: 100 x 65 x 13.7 mm; weight: 105 gm; 10 Whr capacity; 8 W maximum continuous power; 10 W peak power (short duration); four white LEDs for capacity indication; factory-specified charge time: 3.5 hours

Contact: APC
Phone: 1800 4254 272
E-mail: shreya.choudhary@apc.com
Price: Rs. 3,898

RATINGS

Features	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

ATEN CS-62B KVM

Switching made easy

If you're an administrator with more than one PC—say one running Linux and the other, Windows—or if you're an enthusiast with multiple PCs, a device called the KVM switch (Keyboard, Video and Mouse) helps avoid the duplication of keyboard, monitor and mouse. That's what the ATEN CS-62B brings you. The idea is to plug the existing devices into the respective ports on the CS-62B and attach the two PCs to the box via the ten 6-foot-long tentacles.

The CS-62B has two pairs of connectors, consisting of one D-sub connector, two PS/2 connectors, and two audio jacks. These



connect to the respective PCs. The audio jack connects to the audio line-out and mic-in ports on each PC.

We tried this with a Windows and a Linux machine, and we liked the instant switching between machines. The ATEN CS-62B is a cool addition to your arsenal of tools—if you need it, that is.

Specifications

Two-PC connectivity; two PS/2 connectors; two D-SUB connectors; four mini stereo audio jacks; two LED indicators; hotkey switching

Contact: : Cubix Micro Systems
Phone: 020-24251594
E-mail: sales@cubixindia.com
Price: Rs. 2,750 + Taxes

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★